

Year 5 Reading Comprehension - Ocean Plastic

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY05 - use comprehension strategies to analyse information, ideas and literal and inferred meaning in texts.

Learning Intention

I can identify the author's purpose and use evidence to explain a point of view.

Reading Strategy

Notice persuasive language, facts, examples and repeated ideas that show what the author wants readers to do.

Vocabulary Helper

single-use: made to be used once before being thrown away

sustainable: able to continue without causing unnecessary harm

alternative: another choice or option

impact: the effect something has

Before You Read

Predict why a school might challenge students to reduce plastic in their lunchboxes.

The Plastic-Free Lunch Challenge

Every Friday at Banksia Primary, the Year 5 students take part in the Plastic-Free Lunch Challenge. At first, some students think it will be impossible. They are used to snack wrappers, small yoghurt tubs and plastic drink bottles. By the end of the month, many students discover that small changes can become normal habits.

The challenge begins with a class investigation. Students sort a clean sample of lunch waste into paper, soft plastic, hard plastic and food scraps. The largest pile is soft plastic. Maya, the class sustainability leader, explains that soft plastic is often used for only a few minutes but may remain in the environment for a long time.

The class tests alternatives. Some students bring fruit in reusable containers. Others bake muffins at home or wrap sandwiches in cloth. The aim is not to be perfect; it is to notice choices and reduce waste where possible.

At assembly, the class shares their results. The rubbish bin is lighter, younger students ask to join, and families send in new ideas. The challenge shows that a school can make a difference when people learn, try and improve together.

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Questions and written response

Warm Up

Circle the author's main purpose: to entertain / to persuade and inform / to list rules.
Explain your choice.

Build Your Skills

1. What problem does the class notice during the investigation?

2. Why does Maya mention that soft plastic may remain for a long time?

3. What does the text mean by the aim is not to be perfect?

4. Name two alternatives the students try.

5. How does the challenge influence younger students?

6. What evidence shows the challenge had a wider impact?

Strong Challenge

Write a short paragraph agreeing or disagreeing with the challenge. Use at least two details from the text.

I Can

- ☐ I read carefully.
- ☐ I used evidence.
- ☐ I explained my thinking.

High Five!

Great thinking! You identified the author's purpose and used text evidence.

Teacher Feedback

Strength: _____

Next: _____

Ocean Plastic - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Detailed Answers

1. The class notices a large amount of lunch waste, especially soft plastic.
2. To show that a short-use item can have a long-lasting environmental impact.
3. Students should focus on improving choices and reducing waste, not being perfect every day.
4. Reusable containers, homemade muffins and cloth wraps are examples.
5. Younger students ask to join after hearing about the results.
6. The lighter waste bin and interest from younger students show the impact spread beyond one class.

Success Guide

A strong answer explains the author's purpose and supports it with details such as the waste sort, alternatives and assembly results.

Parent Tip - At Home

Try a fun lunchbox audit at home. Count how many items can be reused, recycled or eaten with no wrapper. Make it a challenge, not a lecture.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Use three coloured sticky notes: fact, opinion and action. Students label parts of the passage and discuss how they work together.

Extension Idea

Design a one-sentence slogan for a plastic-free lunch poster.